

EMPLOYEES

~11-50

LinkedIn company size range

WHAT MATTERS

KEY DEBATE

Pre-priced and pre-revenue in trusted sources: no disclosed round size, valuation, ARR, or customer count, so any valuation mark is speculative and the company is years and multiple rounds from an exit.

BUSINESS OVERVIEW

IN ONE SENTENCE

Forgepoint builds AI back-office 'workers' for American manufacturers, starting with an AI Inside Sales Rep that turns RFQs into margin-checked quotes in hours instead of days. Founded 2025 in San Francisco; backed by a16z Speedrun and Company Ventures. No priced round or revenue disclosed.

PLAIN ENGLISH

What it does, who pays

- Forgepoint sells AI 'workers' to American manufacturers, starting with an AI inside sales rep.
- The AI reads incoming RFQs and drafts margin-checked quotes in hours instead of days.
- It layers on top of the customer's existing ERP/CRM rather than replacing it.
- Sold as a SaaS subscription; expanding into purchasing, invoicing, and AR.

THE TECHNICAL VERSION

How it actually works

- Agentic software that ingests RFQs from email, PDF drawings, Excel, and CAD/STP files.
- Builds the bill of materials and pulls real-time pricing from the customer's ERP.
- Applies customer-specific discounts and margin rules before a human approves the quote.
- Founded 2025; backed by a16z Speedrun and Company Ventures; no priced round disclosed.

EXPLAINED SIMPLY

The analogy

- Imagine a tireless sales assistant who reads every quote request the moment it lands.
- It checks the price list, the customer's discount, and the profit margin, then drafts the reply.
- The shop owner just reviews and hits send.

KEY TERMS, DECODED**RFQ** *Request for Quote*

A buyer's ask for a price on specific parts, the document the AI turns into a quote.

ERP *Enterprise Resource Planning*

The system of record where a manufacturer keeps pricing, inventory, and orders.

BOM *Bill of Materials*

The parts-and-quantities list a quote is priced from.

- Forgepoint is a San Francisco AI startup, founded in 2025, building agentic 'AI workers' for the American manufacturing back office.
- Its lead product is an AI Inside Sales Rep that ingests inbound RFQs (email, PDF part drawings, Excel, CAD/STP files), clarifies specs, builds the bill of materials, pulls real-time pricing from the customer's ERP, applies customer-specific discounts and margin rules, routes for approval, and finalizes the quote, compressing a turnaround that typically takes days into a few hours.
- The thesis: a large, under-digitized manufacturing base still runs quoting, purchasing, and invoicing on spreadsheets, email, and manual data entry, and agentic AI is the first viable way to reclaim the speed lost to overseas competitors.
- The company is backed by a16z Speedrun and Company Ventures with angels from Brex, Xwing, and Betterment.
- It is SOC 2 Type II certified and claims sub-30-day deployments.
- No priced funding round, valuation, or revenue figure has been disclosed in trusted sources, and there is effectively no Tier 1/2 press coverage yet, this is a pre-narrative, seed-stage name where founder-market fit and an under-served end market are the entire story.

SOURCES: [FORGEPOINT \(COMPANY WEBSITE\)](#) · [JACK STRAUSS - LINKEDIN](#) · [PITCHBOOK](#) · [FORGEPOINT PROFILE](#)

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

CO-FOUNDER & CEO SINCE 2025

Jack Strauss

Ex-Northrop Grumman and Acer OEM roles; Bain & Co manufacturing practice (semiconductor & aerospace); Chief of Staff then GTM lead at Xwing (AI aviation startup, scaled 25 to 150 employees, acquired by Joby Aviation). Stanford MBA.

CO-FOUNDER & CTO SINCE 2025

Alex Pareto

Previously led engineering for Spend Management at Brex; led engineering at NTRK (Complex); founder of demeanor.co (Y Combinator S18, acquired by NTRK); earlier on Facebook's video platform. BS Computer Science, USC.

PRODUCT & REVENUE MODEL

- Forgepoint sells AI 'workers', software agents that take over discrete manufacturing back-office workflows, on a SaaS basis, landing with the quoting agent and expanding into purchasing, invoicing, AR, and sales coordination.
- The architectural bet is 'AI First, End to End' layered on top of legacy systems: keep the customer's existing ERP, pricing sheets, and workflows, and have Forgepoint sync in real time rather than rip-and-replace the system of record.
- The agent reads messy real-world inputs and connects to a broad library of ERP/CRM connectors (SAP, NetSuite, Epicor, Sage, Infor, Acumatica, Syspro) to read live pricing, then routes margin-checked, approval-gated quotes and runs automated, engagement-aware follow-up.
- A done-for-you integration goes live in under 30 days, and the platform is SOC 2 Type II certified to clear enterprise/industrial security review.
- Pricing and contract structure are not publicly disclosed.

SOURCES: [FORGEPOINT - PRODUCT](#) · [FORGEPOINT - CAREERS / MANIFESTO](#)

RECENT NEWS

2026-06-04

Forgepoint operating as a16z Speedrun-backed seed startup selling AI quoting agents to US manufacturers; SOC 2 Type II certified

SOURCE: [FORGEPOINT \(COMPANY WEBSITE\)](#)

The only verifiable signals, a16z Speedrun backing, an enterprise-grade SOC 2 Type II badge, and a sub-30-day deployment claim, suggest the company is past pure stealth and selling into real accounts, but with no priced round disclosed there is no public valuation anchor for a banker to mark.

2025

Forgepoint listed as a16z Speedrun and Company Ventures portfolio company on PitchBook

SOURCE: [PITCHBOOK](#)

Confirms institutional seed backing and founding year, but PitchBook discloses no round size or valuation, so the financing remains unpriced for diligence purposes.

FINANCIALS & KEY METRICS

Reporting period: Traction snapshot (company-reported, unaudited); reported as of 2026-06-04. Each metric is tagged with the period it covers; LTM and as-of figures are labeled individually.

QUOTE TURNAROUND ~91% faster days to a few hours	REP HOURS SAVED 80+ hrs / rep / month	DEPLOYMENT < 30 days to go-live	SECURITY SOC 2 Type II certified
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- AI / Product:** Product direction centers on agentic 'AI workers' that own end-to-end back-office workflows rather than co-pilot a human. The wedge agent (quoting) ingests RFQs across email, PDF, Excel, and CAD, builds the BOM, applies the shop's own margin and discount rules, routes for approval, and runs engagement-aware follow-up; adjacent agents target purchasing, invoicing, and sales coordination.
- Demand:** Forgepoint publicly frames itself as supply-constrained ('more customer demand than we can serve') and advertises onboarding scarcity. It reports, on a company-reported, unaudited basis, quote turnaround cut roughly 91% (days to hours) and 80+ rep-hours saved per month.

SOURCES: FORGEPOINT - PRODUCT · FORGEPOINT - CAREERS

KEY RISKS & DEBATES

- Pre-priced and pre-revenue in trusted sources:** no disclosed round size, valuation, ARR, or customer count, so any valuation mark is speculative and the company is years and multiple rounds from an exit.
- Crowded agentic-AI field:** AI sales/back-office agents (11x, Artisan, Paradigm) plus incumbent manufacturing-quoting software (Paperless Parts, Xometry) are all chasing adjacent budget; differentiation rests on deep ERP integration and vertical focus that competitors can also pursue.
- Integration and data moat are unproven at scale:** the 'layer on top of any legacy ERP' promise is operationally hard across SAP/Epicor/Infor/Syspro variants; a done-for-you, sub-30-day model can pressure margins and slow scaling if it stays services-heavy.
- Long, relationship-driven manufacturing sales cycles and conservative buyers** can blunt the speed-to-quote pitch; adoption may lag the demand the company describes.
- Key-person and thin-team risk:** a ~11-50 person seed company concentrated around two founders; the company homepage cites 'Y Combinator' while other sources emphasize a16z Speedrun, a minor signal that the public record is still unsettled.

SOURCES: FORGEPOINT (COMPANY WEBSITE) · PITCHBOOK - FORGEPOINT PROFILE

COMPARABLE COMPANIES

COMPANY	TICKER	TYPE	MKT CAP	EV / REV LTM	REV GROWTH YoY	GROSS MARGIN	FCF MARGIN LTM	RULE OF 40 growth + FCF
Samsara Inc. Physical-operations SaaS - reference, not a direct comp	IOT	Adjacent (connected operations)	\$12.5B	6.8x	30.5%	76.3%	14.0%	44
Autodesk, Inc. Design/mfg incumbent - reference, not a direct comp	ADSK	Adjacent (design/mfg software)	\$47.3B	6.3x	18.4%	92.4%	40.8%	59
PTC Inc. Industrial/PLM incumbent - end- market reference, not a direct comp	PTC	Adjacent (industrial/PLM software)	\$15.8B	5.6x	21.7%	84.7%	32.9%	55
Procore Technologies Vertical-SaaS reference, not a direct comp	PCOR	Adjacent (vertical SaaS)	\$6.9B	4.7x	15.7%	79.9%	18.0%	34
Peer median EX-SUBJECT				5.9x	20.0%	82.3%	25.4%	50

GROWTH VS MULTIPLE



SOURCES: Public-ticker multiples pulled live from [yfinance](#) / [Yahoo Finance](#), as of the 2026-06-09 market close; EV/Rev recomputed from last close × shares + net debt. Rev Growth (YoY), Gross Margin, and FCF Margin reflect each company's most recent reported quarter / LTM, so their as-of periods differ by company and from the price close above. Rule of 40 = revenue growth + FCF margin.

FUNDING HISTORY

SEED / EARLY-STAGE (A16Z SPEEDRUN-BACKED)

Undisclosed

Undisclosed

2025

Andreessen Horowitz (a16z Speedrun)

NOTABLE INVESTORS

Andreessen Horowitz (a16z Speedrun)

Company Ventures

Angels from Brex, Xwing, Betterment

IPO READINESS

- Not applicable, very early.
- Founded 2025, seed-stage, ~11-50 employees.
- IPO is many years and multiple rounds away; the near-term path is product-market fit and a priced seed / Series A.

SLIDE-READY BULLETS

- 1 Forgepoint (SF, founded 2025) builds agentic 'AI workers' for the American manufacturing back office, leading with an AI Inside Sales Rep that turns RFQs into margin-checked quotes in hours rather than days.
- 2 Strong founder-market fit: CEO Jack Strauss (ex-Northrop Grumman, Bain manufacturing practice, GTM/Chief of Staff at Xwing to Joby) and CTO Alex Pareto (ex-Brex Head of Engineering for Spend Management, YC S18 founder).
- 3 Backed by a16z Speedrun and Company Ventures with Brex/Xwing/Betterment angels; SOC 2 Type II certified, sub-30-day ERP-integrated deployments. No round size, valuation, or revenue disclosed.
- 4 Wedge-and-expand GTM: land on quoting, expand into purchasing, invoicing, AR, and sales coordination, layering on top of legacy ERPs (SAP, NetSuite, Epicor, Infor, Syspro) rather than replacing them.
- 5 Company-reported, unaudited traction only (quote turnaround ~91% faster, 80+ rep-hours saved/month, 'more demand than we can serve'); no Tier 1/2 press validation yet, diligence is founder, end-market, and PMF, not financials.

SMART DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

- Q1 What are the actual seed round size, post-money valuation, lead, and cap-table terms, and what is current ARR, customer count, logo concentration, and net revenue retention behind the 'more demand than we can serve' framing?

Q2 How defensible is the ERP-integration layer in practice across SAP/Epicor/Infor/Syspro variants, is onboarding productized and software-margin, or services-heavy, and what is gross margin and payback per customer at the current stage?

Q3 In a crowded agentic-AI field (11x, Artisan, Paradigm) and against entrenched manufacturing-quoting incumbents (Paperless Parts, Xometry), what is the durable moat, proprietary pricing data, switching costs, or distribution, and what is the realistic 18-month path to a priced Series A?

Sources: Company IR, earnings transcripts, Bloomberg, SEC filings, Sacra, Crunchbase, yfinance
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ATLAS